

Interview Questions:

1. What is the difference between the department of computer science and the department of computer, mathematical, & natural sciences at UMD?

The Department of Computer Science is a unit within the College of Computer, Mathematical, and Natural Sciences (CMNS).

2. Do you feel the development of AI has grown or contracted the job opportunities in the field of computer science over the last few years?
3. Are you seeing a shift in applicants? Are less applying to computer science and more to AI?

The M.S. in computer science is a research-based master's program that requires a thesis. This program is run by the Department of Computer Science. The M.S. in artificial intelligence is a non-thesis master's program for working professionals. It is run by the CMNS Science Academy. The M.S. in AI courses are taught on campus in the evenings to accommodate those students.

4. What will the Master of Science in Artificial Intelligence add to the computer science program?

The M.S. in artificial intelligence adds to other professional master's programs offered by the CMNS Science Academy, including an M.S. in applied machine learning, an M.S. in data science, an M.S. in bioinformatics and computational biology, and an M.S. in quantum computing. There are nearly 700 students enrolled in these programs in Fall 2025 and 245 students have graduated since the Science Academy launched in 2020.

5. What are you most excited about in the future opportunities for UMD students in the study and field of AI?